

1949 , February 20

(Very Rev. Edmund Kramer)

Rev. Father Provincial

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accompanied me on to Minneapolis, whence, after an hour and a half, I was to take another train and go on two hundred miles further to Ortonville, Minn. , right near the S. Dakota border; thence, after holy Mass next morning drive twenty miles to Graceville for the funeral at ten ocl. It was 3:30 when we pulled into that station. It had been moon-light all night, though rather pale, but with the snow on the ground I heard the train--men's view come out in harmony with my own: "Its a beautiful night".

We were about thirty miles from our train-destiny when I was able to stretch my bones in the empty smoking-car which was better than in a corner of a seat. Thank God that was a relief. I was at least half-asleep, when the gentle brake-man called me and I went out to find the Pastor patiently waiting. We were a half hour late. He, Father George Campbell, tooted when he saw me leave the train and greeted me like an old friend. He has a nice little (Church) - one altar - to accomodate about two or three hundred, St. Mary's. After holy Mass and breakfast, we made the twenty miles in a dense, freezing fog about twenty minutes before services. Father Ed'd had hardly expected me and was disappointed in his figuring on Monsignore Reaordan of Mineapolis - a one-time pastor of M.E.J., to give the sermon. No one else seemed ready for that privilege; so that I was ashamed to decline when asked if I would say a few words. I took the text that came to my mind as we were leaving for the Altar: "Quid Retribuam ...?"Thank God; though a most happy theme if properly developed, it could not, under the circumstances, be more than extempore. It seemed, however, to be satisfactory. A nice crowd of intelligent looking school children together with the silent sermon of a happy death of one who had weathered the storms of 81 winters consecrated to Almighty God, naturally inclined my thoughts to vocations. (for 20 minutes).

(conclusion lost)